

Updated Results

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Table 1: Hybrid Policy Index: Component Variables, Sources, and Geographic Level

Item	Component	Description	Source variable	Level	Dataset
<i>Panel A: Components with county-level GFD analogue (GFD primary; SPPD fallback where noted)</i>					
1	TANF / AFDC	Categorical and general cash assistance expenditure per 1,000 residents; falls back to state maximum monthly TANF/AFDC benefit (2023\$) when county GFD data absent	Welf_Categ_Cash_Assist + Welf_Cash_Cash_Assist (GFD); TANF2023 (SPPD)	County / State	GFD / SPPD
5	Medicaid	Vendor medical payments per 1,000 residents; no state-level fallback (Medicaid expansion is NA pre-2014 in SPPD)	Welf_Vend_Pmts_Medicaid	County	GFD
<i>Panel B: Components without county analogue (state-level SPPD only)</i>					
2	SNAP	Maximum monthly SNAP food-stamp allotment for a two-person household (2023\$)	SNAP_2023	State	SPPD
3	EITC	State EITC rate as a percentage of the federal credit	eitc	State	SPPD
4	Minimum wage	State minimum wage (2023\$); set to federal level if no state law	state_minwage_2023	State	SPPD
6	Unemployment ins.	Maximum annual unemployment insurance benefit (2023\$)	ui_max_2023	State	SPPD
7	Paid sick leave	Indicator: state paid sick leave law in effect (proportion of decade years)	psl	State	SPPD
8	Right-to-work	Reversed indicator: 1 – RTW law, so higher = no RTW = more liberal	1 - rtw	State	SPPD
9	Labor preemption	Negative count of six labor-related preemption laws in effect, so higher = less preemption	-preempt_total	State	SPPD
10	Tobacco tax	State cigarette tax per pack (2023\$)	tobaccotax_2023	State	SPPD
11	Firearm laws	Count of restrictive firearm laws in effect: child access protection + (1 – stand-your-ground) + (1 – right-to-carry); ranges 0–3	CAP + (1–SYG) + (1–RTC)	State	SPPD

Notes: The composite index (**lib_index_final**) follows the construction in Montez et al. 2026: (1) each component is normalized to [0, 1] globally across all county-decades and all three decades (1980, 1990, 2000); (2) available normalized scores are summed per county-decade; (3) the sum is re-normalized to [0, 1]. SPPD variables are averaged within the corresponding GFD decade window (1980–1989; 1990–1999; 2000–2005) before merging. GFD spending figures are decade-averaged and expressed per 1,000 residents using NHGIS decennial census population denominators (nhgis0017). The variable **tanf_source** records whether item 1 derives from county GFD data (**county_gfd**) or the state SPPD fallback (**state_sppd**). Item 5 (Medicaid) has no state-level fallback because **medicaidexp** in SPPD is missing for all pre-2014 years. Washington, D.C. (FIPS 11001) has no GFD coverage and is excluded from SPPD; its index value is missing across all three decades. GFD = Government Finance Database. SPPD = State Policies and Politics Database (ICPSR 246713.).